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PDF GUIDE · MOBILITY & RECOVERY

TRAINING TAKES. RECOVERY GIVES BACK.

Sleep, fatigue, mobility, soft-tissue work and injury prevention. Everything that happens between sessions and decides whether you get through twelve weeks fit and in one piece.

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01 · THE PRINCIPLE

FITNESS IS BUILT IN RECOVERY.

Training is the stimulus. You only get fitter and stronger once your body has the time and the raw materials to repair. Recovery is part of the plan, not a reward for a hard week.

Every session makes you a little weaker for a while. After 1 km repeats or a heavy sled push you are carrying fatigue, micro-damage in the muscle, depleted glycogen and a nervous system running on reserve. Give your body sleep, food and sensible rest and it repairs itself, then sets itself a notch higher than before. That is adaptation.

Skip the rest and the next session lands on a body that hasn't been fixed yet. One week like that is fine. Three or four in a row and it shows: paces that normally feel easy start to hurt, you wake up at night, you crave sugar and you have to drag yourself to the gym. Doing more won't fix that. Doing less and sleeping will.

Load	+ Rest	= Adaptation
STIMULUS · TRAINING	REPAIR · SLEEP, FOOD	RESULT · PERFORMANCE

WHY IT MATTERS DOUBLE IN HYROX

HYROX mixes running and strength. Eight kilometres of running plus eight stations where you push, pull, carry, jump and throw. So fatigue stacks up from several sources at once. Running hammers calves, Achilles and shins with repeated impact. Sleds and lunges load the quads and glutes. Farmers carry and sled pull tax grip, traps and back. Wall balls and the SkiErg go after the shoulders.

Add 2 runs and 2 strength / HYROX sessions a week plus classes at Form Factory, all fitted around work and family. You have to schedule recovery as deliberately as training. Otherwise the rest of your life eats it.

THE FOUR PILLARS OF RECOVERY

PILLAR	WHAT IT DOES	THE MINIMUM WE WANT
Sleep	Hormonal repair, motor learning, nervous system, appetite	7–9 hours, consistent bed and wake times
Food and fluids	Building blocks for repair, glycogen refill	Protein at every meal, carbs around training, enough fluids (details in the nutrition guide)

PILLAR	WHAT IT DOES	THE MINIMUM WE WANT
Load management	Keeps fatigue below your capacity	Morning check, smart session order, deload in week 6
Movement and tissue	Range of motion, blood flow, tissue quality	10 minutes of mobility a day, easy movement on rest days

Notice the order. Foam rollers, saunas and compression socks come last. They're nice, but they won't rescue bad sleep and an empty plate. When clients ask me which recovery gadget to buy, my usual answer is blackout curtains and an alarm that tells you to go to bed.

> Twelve weeks aren't won in one heroic session. They're won by getting through 45 of 48 sessions, and not having to force yourself through any of them.

THE MAIN RULE

Plan recovery in advance, not when you've already hit the wall. Put training and sleep in your calendar. Both are part of your race prep.

WHAT RECOVERY IS

- Sleep, food, hydration
- Easy movement on rest days
- Mobility and tissue care
- A planned deload
- A head that switches off for a while

WHAT RECOVERY ISN'T

- A whole weekend on the sofa
- An "easy" session that ends up all-out
- Post-race beers as rehydration
- An hour of rolling instead of sleep
- An excuse to skip training

02 · SLEEP

SLEEP IS THE BEST SUPPLEMENT YOU'LL EVER TAKE.

Nothing else in this guide has as much impact on recovery. And nothing else gets sacrificed so easily.

While you sleep, your body repairs muscle and tendon, stores the movement patterns you practised that day and resets your nervous system. After a short night your reactions are slower, the same pace feels harder, you want to train less and you want sugar more. People who regularly sleep under 7 hours usually recover worse and get sick more often.

7–9 h	±30 min	8 h	60 min
SLEEP PER NIGHT	SAME TIMES, WEEKENDS TOO	CAFFEINE-FREE BEFORE BED	SCREEN-FREE

HOW MUCH

Adults need 7–9 hours. Athletes in a training block should aim for the top of that range. Count time asleep, not time in bed. If you go to bed at 11 but scroll until midnight, you slept an hour less than you think.

If 7 hours a night just isn't happening, a 15–25 minute nap before 3 pm helps.

AN EVENING ROUTINE THAT WORKS

01 **Fixed times.** Go to bed and get up at the same time, give or take 30 minutes, weekends included. Rhythm matters more than one long Saturday lie-in.

02 **Wind down for an hour.** Dim the lights, no work, no email. Phone out of the bedroom.

03 **Dark, cool, quiet bedroom.** Around 17–19 °C, blackout curtains or an eye mask, earplugs. Bed is for sleeping.

04 **Brain dump.** Write down the three things you have to do tomorrow. Your brain doesn't have to hold on to them overnight.

05 **A few minutes of breathing.** Lie on your back, in through the nose for 4, out for 6–8. Five minutes is plenty.

CAFFEINE, ALCOHOL, SCREENS

Caffeine has a half-life of around 5 hours, longer for some people. That 4 pm coffee is still partly in your system at midnight. Have your last caffeine roughly 8 hours before bed. Watch out for pre-workouts before evening sessions.

Alcohol helps you fall asleep, but the sleep is shallower, you wake more and you recover worse. Two beers in the evening can easily show up as a higher morning heart rate and heavy legs in training. Keep it to a minimum in the final weeks before the race.

Screens are mostly a problem because of what's on them. Work email or an endless feed keeps your brain on alert. An hour screen-free is the cheapest performance supplement there is.

FROM THE COACHING FLOOR

A client, a manager with two small kids, was getting 5.5–6 hours a night. He was flat in training and couldn't hold any pace. We didn't change his programme. We changed one thing: lights out at 10:15 and the phone stays in the kitchen. Three weeks later he was getting an extra hour of sleep and his Zone 2 pace at the same heart rate was noticeably quicker.

SLEPT BADLY. NOW WHAT?

One bad night won't break anything. Don't panic and don't chase it with a 4 pm espresso. Go to bed a bit earlier the next night, but not three hours earlier. If a hard session is on the plan, use the morning check in chapter 03. After one bad night you'll usually train as normal. After two or three in a row, back off the intensity or swap the order of your sessions that week.

BAD SLEEP BEFORE THE RACE

Almost everyone sleeps badly the night before a race. Nerves, a strange bed, an early alarm. The good news: sleep two and three nights out matters more for performance than the last one. So sleep properly all race week and take the final night as it comes. Lie there, breathe, don't watch the clock. Quiet rest still helps. Pack an eye mask and earplugs if you're travelling.

THE MAIN RULE

If it's a choice between a 5:30 am session on four hours of sleep and an extra hour in bed, sleep wins most of the time. You can move a session. You can't make up lost sleep.

03 · STRESS AND FATIGUE

YOUR BODY CAN'T TELL WHERE STRESS COMES FROM.

A work deadline, a sick kid, moving house and track intervals all draw from the same tank. Learn to read the gauge.

The plan you get every Monday doesn't know that you're presenting to the board on Tuesday, travelling for work on Wednesday and up twice in the night with the kids. You know. That's why you're the one who adjusts it now and then.

Total load = training + life. When life gets heavy, training has to give a little for a while. That doesn't mean skipping. It means training smart.

Outside training, these count: work pressure and travel, young kids, short sleep, a cold coming on, under-eating, emotional stress. **Inside training:** intervals and race pace, higher volume, heavy stations, simulations, extra classes on top of the plan, new shoes.

MORNING CHECK: 30 SECONDS, EVERY DAY

When you wake up, before coffee, score four things from 1 to 5. Add them up and write the total down. One bad day is noise. Three days in a row under 11 is a signal. And be honest with yourself.

AREA	1	3	5
Sleep	Under 5 h, broken night	6–7 h, fine	8 h or more, rested
Mood	Irritable, nothing's fun	Normal	Good, full of energy
Muscles	Sore at rest, heavy legs	Can feel yesterday	Light, fresh
Drive to train	None, forcing it	I'll do it	Can't wait

TOTAL	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
16–20	You're good	Train as planned. Push if you feel like it.
11–15	Normal training fatigue	Train as planned with a proper warm-up. Decide after the first block whether to go full gas.

TOTAL	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
7–10	Elevated fatigue	Back off. Cut intervals by a third or swap them for Zone 2. Strength without max sets.
4–6	Running on empty	Easy movement, mobility, walking only. If it lasts more than 2–3 days, message us in the group.

WHEN TO BACK OFF

Watch for these on top of your score. Two or more at once mean ease off, even if the plan says build.

- Pace or heart rate on a familiar session is clearly worse than usual and doesn't improve once you're warm
- Resting heart rate is roughly 5–7 beats above your normal for several mornings in a row
- You struggle to fall asleep despite being tired, or keep waking up

HOW TO BACK OFF SMART

SITUATION	ADJUSTMENT
Brutal week at work	Do all 4 sessions, but cut intervals and heavy sets by 20–30 %. Skip the extra class.
Illness	Above the neck only (runny nose): easy movement ok, no intensity. Fever, aching muscles, chesty cough: no training, back only after 1–2 days fever-free.

HRV AND RESTING HEART RATE: A GOOD SERVANT

If your watch or ring tracks HRV (heart rate variability) and resting heart rate, use them as a supplement. Look at the 7-day trend, not a single morning. Falling HRV and rising resting heart rate over several days say the same thing as a low morning check score.

But a device can't feel how you feel. Watch says "not ready" but you slept well and you're keen? Warm up and decide based on the first ten minutes. Your morning check outranks the app.

THE MAIN RULE

Dropping one session is a decision. Losing two weeks to illness or injury is a consequence. Choose the first.

04 · ACTIVE RECOVERY AND DELOAD

REST DOESN'T MEAN SITTING STILL.

Easy movement on rest days speeds up recovery more than a day on the sofa. And the planned deload in week 6 is where all the banked work turns into performance.

ACTIVE RECOVERY

Active recovery is movement so easy that you finish fresher than you started. It gets blood into the muscles, loosens up the joints and clears your head. If you feel tired afterwards, it wasn't recovery. It was another workout.

ACTIVITY	DURATION	INTENSITY AND NOTES
Walking	30–60 min	The simplest and most underrated. Brisk, outdoors, phone in your pocket.
Bike, spin bike	20–45 min	Easy, high cadence, just spin the legs out. Joint-friendly.
Swimming	20–30 min	Relaxed, no intervals. Good for back and shoulders.
Mobility	10–20 min	Routines from chapter 06.

ZONE 2: TRAINING AND RECOVERY IN ONE

Zone 2 is a pace where you can talk in full sentences. Your 1 km time trial gave you individual pace zones, so you know exactly what that pace is for you. An easy run or ride in Zone 2 builds your aerobic base while barely tiring you out. That's why you'll see it in the plan a lot.

The biggest mistake I see: Zone 2 turns into "moderately quick because I felt good". The result is easy days that are too hard and hard days that are too easy, because you've got nothing left. Stick to your zones. If you have to walk the hills to keep your heart rate down, walk.

WEEK 6: DELOAD

After five weeks of building the base and the first week of intensity comes week 6. On the plan: a deload and Workshop 2 (Mid-program check). A deload isn't a week off. We pull back so your body can catch up on the adaptations from previous weeks and you go into the performance phase (weeks 7–9) fresh.

WHAT	NORMAL WEEK	DELOAD WEEK
Volume	Full, according to phase	Much lower, shorter sessions and fewer sets
Intensity	As planned	Touch it briefly and sharply, but no long blocks into fatigue
Strength	Progressing loads	Lighter loads, clean technique, no maxes
Running	Intervals, tempo, volume	Mostly easy running, a few short pick-ups to stay sharp
Recovery	10 min mobility daily	More sleep, more walking, longer mobility

You get the actual deload week in the training app on Monday as usual. The table shows the principle.

COMING BACK AFTER A BREAK

The mistake is jumping straight back in where you left off. Tendons and bones re-adapt to impact more slowly than your lungs. Break of up to a week: normal plan, first session easier. 1–2 weeks: roughly 70 % of volume in the first week. 2–4 weeks: roughly 50–60 % of volume, no max intervals or simulations, build back over 2 weeks. Over 4 weeks or after an injury, message us and we'll set up an individual return.

WHY THE DELOAD WORKS

Adaptation doesn't happen during training, it happens afterwards. After several weeks of gradually increasing load, accumulated fatigue masks how much fitter you've actually got. Pull back for a week and fatigue clears faster than fitness fades. Often in week 7 you'll find that the pace you were fighting in week 5 suddenly feels doable.

FROM THE COACHING FLOOR

The classic deload-week sin: "I feel great, so I'll add a bit." Of course you feel great. That's because you're backing off. Add more and you kill the effect and roll into week 7 tired. Spend the energy elsewhere: go over station technique with us, sort out your sleep, take a longer walk.

THE MAIN RULE

Keep easy days genuinely easy so hard days can be genuinely hard. The grey zone in between wears you out and builds nothing.

05 · MOBILITY FOR HYROX

GET MOBILE WHERE YOU ACTUALLY RACE.

You don't need the splits or a backbend. You need enough range in your ankles, hips, thoracic spine and shoulders to hold good positions on the stations at minute 70.

Mobility isn't the same as flexibility. Mobility is range you can actively control and use under load. When it's missing, your body finds the movement somewhere else. Missing ankle comes from the knee. Missing hip and upper back come from the lower back. Missing shoulder comes from arching. You'll get away with it for a few reps. Not for 100 wall balls and 100 m of lunges deep in race fatigue.

WHAT HYROX NEEDS, AND WHERE

AREA	WHERE YOU NEED IT	WHAT HAPPENS WHEN IT'S MISSING
Ankles	Running, sled push, lunges, wall ball squat	Knees cave in, heels lift, overloaded calves and Achilles
Hips	Lunges, wall balls, burpee broad jumps, running stride	Short stride, rounded back in the squat, cranky lower back and knees
Thoracic spine	SkiErg, rowing, wall balls, farmers carry, running posture	Rounded back, shoulders forward, overloaded lower back and neck
Shoulders	Wall balls, SkiErg, sled pull, burpees	Arching the lower back on the throw, pain at the front of the shoulder

TEST YOURSELF: 5 TESTS IN 10 MINUTES

Do them in week 1, then again around weeks 6 and 12. Write down the results. The point isn't to be the best. The point is to find your weakest link and see whether it's improving. If any test hurts, stop and let us know.

KNEE-TO-WALL

ANKLE · BOTH SIDES

Barefoot, facing a wall, one foot forward. Drive the knee towards the wall without the heel lifting, knee tracking over the middle of the foot. Find the furthest toe-to-wall distance at which the knee still touches. **Rough guide:** about 10 cm or more is good, under 8 cm is a restriction worth working on. Note any side-to-side difference over 2 cm.

DEEP SQUAT

ANKLE, HIPS, UPPER BACK

Feet shoulder-width, arms out in front. Sink as low as you can, heels down, back flat. Hold for 30 s. **Look for:** Do your heels lift? Does your back round? Do your knees cave? Can you hold it with arms overhead? That's the position you need for wall balls.

THOMAS TEST

HIP FLEXORS · BOTH SIDES

Sit on the end of a bench, lie back and hug one knee to your chest. Let the other leg hang. **Good:** the hanging thigh sits level or lower and the shin hangs straight down. **Restricted:** the thigh lifts up or the knee drifts out. Tight hip flexors shorten your stride and pull your lower back into an arch.

SEATED ROTATION

THORACIC SPINE · BOTH SIDES

Sit astride a bench or chair, a dowel or broomstick across your upper back, hands on it. Keep your hips square and rotate. **Rough guide:** about 45° or more each way is good. Mainly look at the difference between sides and whether you're cheating with your hips.

WALL OVERHEAD REACH

SHOULDERS, UPPER BACK

Stand with your back to a wall, heels slightly away, lower back against the wall. Raise straight arms forward and overhead and try to touch the wall with your thumbs. **Good:** thumbs on the wall, lower back stays down, ribs don't flare. **Restricted:** arms don't reach, or only reach by arching. You'll see this on every wall ball.

TEST LOG

TEST	WEEK 1	WEEK 6	WEEK 12
Knee-to-wall L / R (cm)			
Deep squat (ok / heels / back / knees)			
Thomas test L / R			
Seated rotation L / R			
Overhead reach (ok / restricted)			

THE MAIN RULE

The tests tell you where to spend your time. Pick drills for your weak spot from the routines in chapter 06 and give them five to ten minutes almost every day. An hour of stretching once a week won't build mobility.

06 · ROUTINES

TEN MINUTES. EVERY DAY.

Three ready-made routines: daily, post-run and post-strength or HYROX session. No thinking required. Start the timer and go.

The routines cover the four areas from chapter 05. Doses are a starting point. If you're restricted somewhere, add an extra set there. Stretches should be uncomfortable at most 6 out of 10, never painful.

A · DAILY ROUTINE (10 MINUTES)

Morning, during a work break or before bed. All you need is a mat and a wall.

KNEE-TO-WALL ROCKS 2 × 10 / SIDE	Same position as the test. Rhythmically drive the knee to the wall and back, heel stays down. Every few reps, move the foot back a little. **Watch out:** knee tracks over the second and third toes, doesn't cave in.
HALF-KNEELING HIP FLEXOR 2 × 45 S / SIDE	Kneel on one knee, other foot in front. Squeeze the glute on the down-knee side, tuck the pelvis under, and only then shift slightly forward. Reach the arm on the back-leg side overhead if you like. **Watch out:** don't arch your lower back. You should feel it at the front of the hip, not in your back.
WORLD'S GREATEST STRETCH 5 / SIDE	From a lunge, put both hands inside the front foot, drop the front elbow towards the floor, then rotate that arm up to the ceiling and follow it with your eyes. **Watch out:** back leg straight, rotation from the upper back, not the shoulder.
OPEN BOOK 8 / SIDE	Lie on your side, knees bent at 90°, arms straight in front of you. Sweep the top arm in an arc and open your chest to the other side. Breathe out and relax. **Watch out:** keep the knees stacked on the floor, otherwise the rotation comes from your lower back.
DEEP SQUAT HOLD 2 × 30–45 S	Sink into a deep squat, push your elbows into your knees and open the hips. If you fall backwards, hold a door frame or put a small plate under your heels. **Watch out:** chest up, breathe into your belly.
WALL SLIDES 10 REPS	Back, head and forearms on the wall, elbows at shoulder height. Slide your arms up the wall and back down. **Watch out:** lower back stays on the wall, ribs down. Only go as high as you can without arching.

B · POST-RUN (6–8 MINUTES)

Jog the last 3–5 minutes very easy, then do this straight away, before you get in the car.

CALF STRETCH
45 S / SIDE, STRAIGHT + BENT KNEE

Lean against a wall, one leg back. First with a straight knee (gastrocnemius), then with a slight bend (soleus, the deeper layer). **Watch out:** heel down, foot pointing forward.

COUCH STRETCH
45–60 S / SIDE

Back knee by a wall or sofa, back foot propped up behind you, front leg in a lunge. Tuck the pelvis and squeeze the glute. **Watch out:** it's an intense quad stretch. If it's too much, move the knee further from the wall.

C · POST-STRENGTH OR HYROX SESSION (8–10 MINUTES)

After sleds, lunges, carries and wall balls your glutes, quads, grip, back and shoulders are cooked. The couch stretch from routine B belongs here too.

DEAD HANG
2 × 20–30 S

Relaxed hang, let the shoulders rise towards your ears, feet on the floor if you need to take weight off. Decompresses the spine after carries and sleds. **Watch out:** if your shoulder hurts, skip it and do child's pose instead.

PIGEON OR 90/90
60 S / SIDE

Pigeon pose or a 90/90 sit leaning over the front leg. Releases the glutes and hip external rotators after lunges. **Watch out:** no pulling in the knee. If your knee complains, use the 90/90, it's gentler.

THREAD THE NEEDLE
6 / SIDE

On all fours, thread one arm under your body, rest the shoulder and side of your head on the floor. Then rotate the arm up to the ceiling. **Watch out:** hips stay over the knees.

FOREARM STRETCH
30 S / SIDE, PALM UP AND DOWN

Arm straight out in front, gently pull the fingers back with the other hand. Your grip will thank you after farmers carry and sled pull.

THE MAIN RULE

The best routine is the one you actually do. Five minutes every day beats 40 minutes once in a while. Tie routine A to something you already do daily: morning coffee, brushing your teeth, the evening news.

07 · SOFT-TISSUE WORK AND TOOLS

TOOLS HELP. THEY DON'T SAVE YOU.

Foam rollers, balls, massage, sauna, cold water. What makes sense, how much is enough and when to skip it. From a coach who's also a sports massage therapist.

FOAM ROLLER AND BALL

Rolling gives you a short-term boost in range of motion, eases stiffness and helps with post-training soreness. It doesn't lengthen muscle or "break up" fascia, however often it's sold that way. It works best short and sweet, before mobility work or a warm-up.

AREA	TOOL	DURATION	TIP
Calves	Roller or ball	60–90 s / side	Stack one leg on the other for more pressure, slowly rotate the foot
Quads	Roller	60–90 s / side	Face down, slowly, pause on a tender spot and bend the knee
Glutes	Ball or roller	60–90 s / side	Sit on the ball, ankle crossed over the opposite knee
Upper back	Roller across the back	60 s	Hands behind your head, stay in the upper half of the back

HOW TO ROLL

- Slowly, roughly 2–3 cm per second
- Pause on a tender spot for 20–30 s and breathe
- Pressure around 5–7 out of 10, not teeth-gritting
- 5–10 minutes in total is enough
- Best before mobility work or in the evening

WHERE NOT TO

- Directly on bones and joints (knee, ankle, shin bone)
- Lower back directly over the spine
- Front and sides of the neck
- Fresh bruises, swollen or red areas

MASSAGE

As a sports massage therapist, I'll be straight with you: massage won't make you fitter on its own, but it can help. It eases stiffness, reduces perceived soreness, calms your head and often spots an area that's being overloaded before it starts to hurt. Like one calf being far tighter than the other.

WHEN	WHAT KIND	WHY
During the block	Sports massage, medium depth, every 2–4 weeks	Tissue check, release, prevention
2–3 days before the race	Lighter and shorter, just a flush	Fresh legs, not sore ones
Day before the race	Nothing new, a light shake-out at most	Deep work can leave muscles flat for a day

SAUNA

Sauna relaxes you and helps you sleep. Used regularly, it may also help a little with heat adaptation. Do 2–3 rounds of 8–15 minutes, cooling off and drinking in between. After a hard session, rehydrate and eat first. Not with a fever, a cold or after alcohol, and check with a doctor first if you have heart or blood pressure issues. Before the race, keep it short and only if you're used to it.

COLD WATER: USEFUL, BUT NOT ALWAYS

An ice bath or cold shower after training reduces perceived soreness and people feel fresher. There's a catch. Cold water straight after strength training blunts the inflammatory response that's part of the signal to adapt. Studies show that regular ice baths right after strength sessions can slow long-term gains in strength and muscle. In a block where you want to build strength, that's a bad trade.

SITUATION	COLD WATER?	WHY
Straight after strength training in a block	Better not	May blunt strength adaptation. Wait at least a few hours or skip it.
After an easy run, in the morning, for the head	Sure	A short cold shower to wake up won't hurt anything
After a race, between back-to-back races	Yes	The goal is to feel better fast, not to adapt
Race week and taper	Only if you're used to it	Nothing new before the race

If you do cold water: 10–15 °C, 3–10 minutes, never alone in open water, never after alcohol.

THE MAIN RULE

Sleep, food and sensible load first. Then mobility. Tools come last. Flip that order and you'll pay for expensive kit and still recover badly.

08 · INJURY PREVENTION AND PAIN

INJURIES DON'T JUST HAPPEN. THEY BUILD UP.

Most injuries don't come out of nowhere. They come from overload your body was flagging two or three weeks earlier.

Thousands of steps, dozens of lunges, a hundred wall balls, all under fatigue. The most common cause I see with clients isn't a bad exercise. It's "too much, too soon": a sudden jump in volume, new shoes, a week of bad sleep.

TYPICAL HYROX OVERLOAD INJURIES

AREA	WHERE IT COMES FROM	WARNING SIGNS
Calves and Achilles	Fast increase in running, running off the sled push, weak calves	Morning stiffness above the heel, pain at the start of a run, tendon tender to squeeze
Shins	Too much running too soon, hard surfaces, new shoes	Pain along the inner edge of the shin during and after running
Knees	Lunges and wall balls under fatigue, knee caving in, weak glutes	Pain below or around the kneecap, worse going downstairs
Lower back	Sled pull, farmers carry, rounded back, weak trunk	Stiff lower back after training, pain bending forward
Shoulders	Wall balls, SkiErg, burpees, stiff upper back	Pain at the front of the shoulder lifting the arm or lying on that side at night

THE STRENGTH MINIMUM

Insurance against the overloads above. 2–3 times a week at the end of a strength session or as a standalone 15 minutes. For shoulders, add face pulls or band pull-aparts, 2–3 × 15–20.

STANDING CALF RAISES

3 × 12–15 / LEG + SEATED 3 × 15

Single leg, forefoot on a step. Up in 1 s, hold 1 s, down in 3 s below step level. Add load once you can do 15 clean reps. Seated with a weight on your knees hits the soleus, which takes a big share of the load when you run.

TIBIALIS RAISES 2-3 × 15-20	Back against a wall, heels about 30 cm out. Lift your toes as high as you can and lower slowly. When it gets easy, walk your heels further out. Shin splint prevention.
COPENHAGEN PLANK 2-3 × 15-30 S / SIDE	Side plank with the top leg on a bench, supported at the inside of the knee (easier) or the ankle (harder). Strong adductors stabilise knee and hip in the lunge.
HIP THRUST 3 × 8-12	Shoulder blades on a bench, barbell or plate on your hips. Drive the hips up, squeeze the glutes at the top and hold 1–2 s. Strong glutes keep the knee in line. **Watch out:** ribs down, don't arch your lower back.

PAIN VS. FATIGUE: THE TRAFFIC LIGHT

Fatigue is dull, spread across the whole muscle and eases once you warm up. Problem pain is sharp, in one spot, often near a tendon or joint, and gets worse as you move. Rate it 0–10. The next morning decides: same or better is fine, worse means it was too much.

LIGHT	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	WHAT TO DO
Green	Fatigue, DOMS, pain 0–2/10, goes away once warm. Not worse next morning.	Carry on as planned.
Amber	Pain 3–5/10 in a specific spot, doesn't get worse during the session, settles by morning.	Adjust. Reduce volume or intensity, swap the painful exercise for a pain-free version. If it's not improving within a week, message us.
Red	Pain above 5/10, sharp or stabbing, rises as you move, changes your stride or technique, worse next morning. Swelling, limping.	Stop. Don't do that movement today, train what doesn't hurt and let us know. Anything from the box below: see a doctor or physio.

WHEN TO SEE A DOCTOR OR PHYSIO

- Chest pain or pressure, palpitations, fainting, unusual breathlessness. Stop immediately and call for help.
- Sudden sharp pain with a "pop", rapid swelling or being unable to put weight on the leg. Very dark urine with extreme muscle pain after a session.
- Bone pain in one spot (shin, foot, hip) that gets worse with running and jumping. Possible stress fracture.
- Pain that wakes you at night or won't settle at rest. Tingling, numbness or weakness in a limb.

This guide doesn't replace a medical assessment. If you're unsure, get it checked.

09 · WEEKLY PLAN AND CHEAT SHEET

BUILD YOUR RECOVERY WEEK.

An example of fitting recovery into a week with 2 runs, 2 strength / HYROX sessions and a class at Form Factory. Plus a cheat sheet to print and stick on the fridge.

You get the plan every Monday for the whole week and spread it across your own days. Here's one version that works. The principles matter more than the exact days: put at least one easier day between two hard leg sessions, and keep one day a week genuinely easy.

DAY	TRAINING	RECOVERY	NOTES
Monday	Strength / HYROX 1	Routine C after the session	New plan in the app, map out your week
Tuesday	Run 1 (intervals / tempo)	Routine B after the run	Proper warm-up, morning check decides
Wednesday	Rest or easy movement	30–60 min walk, routine A	Good day for rolling and an early night
Thursday	Strength / HYROX 2	Routine C, strength minimum	Calves, tibialis, Copenhagen
Friday	Rest	Routine A, massage or sauna if you like	No ice bath straight after Thursday's strength session
Saturday	Run 2 (longer, Zone 2)	Routine B, walking	Longer run at an easy pace
Sunday	HYROX class at FF or rest	Routine A, meal prep for the week	Class if you've got the energy. After a tough week, rest.

RECOVERY BY PROGRAMME PHASE

WEEKS	PHASE	RECOVERY FOCUS
PHASE 1 · BASE		
01–04	Adaptation, base, technique, volume	Set your sleep rhythm, learn routine A, baseline mobility tests. Your body is getting used to volume, so keep an eye on calves and shins.
PHASE 2 · PERFORMANCE		

WEEKS	PHASE	RECOVERY FOCUS
05	Intensity	Morning check every day. Intense weeks need more sleep.
06	Deload + Workshop 2	Back off, sleep, second round of mobility tests. Don't add extra.
07–09	Specific, simulation, peak week	Highest load of the programme. Sleep, fuel around training, don't skip the strength minimum. Watch the traffic light.
PHASE 3 · RACE		
10–11	Taper, race week	Less volume, more sleep. Nothing new: no new massage, sauna, cold plunges or shoes.
12	Finale + Workshop 3	Final tests including mobility. After the race, a few days of easy movement and walking.

AFTER THE RACE

The race will beat you up more than any training session. First 2–3 days: walking, easy cycling and routine A only. Eat normally, get protein and carbs in, sleep. An easy run usually after 3–5 days, depending on how you feel. Build back into hard training over the next week or two.

PRINTABLE CHEAT SHEET

EVERY DAY

- [ ] Morning check: sleep, mood, muscles, drive (4–20 pts)
- [ ] 7–9 hours of sleep
- [ ] Last caffeine 8 hours before bed
- [ ] Routine A, 10 minutes
- [ ] Protein at every meal, enough fluids

EVERY WEEK

- [ ] Routine B after every run
- [ ] Routine C after every strength / HYROX session
- [ ] Strength minimum 2–3×
- [ ] At least 1 genuinely easy day
- [ ] No ice bath straight after strength

MORNING CHECK

- **16–20** plan as written, push if you like
- **11–15** plan, decide after warm-up
- **7–10** cut by a third, or Zone 2
- **4–6** movement and mobility only

PAIN TRAFFIC LIGHT

- **Green 0–2** carry on
- **Amber 3–5** adjust, check next morning
- **Red above 5** stop, message us
- **Alert** doctor or physio

STR2G HYROX

PLAN. TRAIN. PERFORM.

Got a question? Drop it in the WhatsApp group. We, your coaches, answer.

STRONGER TOGETHER.